ACTIVITY 6

Diagnose Hotspots and Set a Reduction Baseline

ISO 14064-1:2018 Greenhouse Gas (GHG) Emissions and Removals
TGS-2025055502 · K3 · A1 · LO3 · 50 minutes

Objective

Use inventory, lifecycle and business data to identify hotspots, set a defensible baseline and frame reduction opportunities.

Scenario

EcoForge's largest reported sources are purchased aluminium, product electricity use, imported electricity, air freight and refrigerant leakage. Data quality varies: electricity is metered, aluminium uses spend-based data, use-phase emissions rely on assumptions and freight distances are estimated.

Materials

- 2025 category inventory
- Product lifecycle facts
- Data-quality ratings
- Hotspot and baseline workbook

Activity questions

- Which sources are largest and which are most influenceable?
- Where can lifecycle burden shift occur?
- Which baseline metrics suit growth and efficiency decisions?
- What data improvements could change prioritisation?

Required evidence

- Hotspot dashboard
- Lifecycle map
- Baseline and intensity statement
- Prioritised opportunity shortlist

Detailed Procedure

1. Rank sources by absolute emissions, trend, data quality, organisational influence and stakeholder significance.

2. Map the product lifecycle from material extraction through manufacturing, transport, use and end of life.

3. Identify potential burden shifts, such as lightweight material that increases energy use or recycling claims that ignore yield loss.

4. Define an absolute baseline and at least one intensity metric with denominator rationale.

5. Separate near-term operational levers from supplier, product-design and customer-use levers.

6. Create an opportunity shortlist using abatement potential, feasibility, cost, lead time and evidence confidence.

7. Run a sensitivity check on the two weakest high-impact assumptions.

8. State which additional primary data is needed before investment approval.

Acceptance Check

Priorities reflect magnitude, influence and uncertainty; baseline and intensity denominator are explicit; no recommendation creates an undisclosed lifecycle burden shift.

Learner completion checklist

Done	Evidence / output	Reviewer comment
■	Hotspot dashboard	
■	Lifecycle map	
■	Baseline and intensity statement	
■	Prioritised opportunity shortlist	